Website Planning

Website Type & Purpose

Professional website

I plan to create a portfolio website that showcases some of the projects that I have created in my courses. With this website I can show future employers a portfolio that will portray the skills that I have built in this program. I am in the Learning Technologies graduate program and my goal is to go into the instructional design field specifically for UX Design. For the projects that I will include, I am going to add in images of wireframes and prototypes that I have created. To provide more detail for the projects, there will be case studies attached with the wireframes.

Home Page Content

Welcome to my portfolio on the UX Design case studies that I have worked on. The purpose of this portfolio is to demonstrate the skills that I have built through the work in my courses.

The courses in my graduate program have given me the opportunities to practice and use the skills that I was taught. My goal at the end of this program is to be able to work in the UX Design field. My background is in Education where I have worked with younger students. I hope to use my experience in Education to help me understand users and the problems that they may face. One of the most important parts of UX Design is viewing problems and solutions from the users' point of view. When I worked with younger students I had to try to understand their perspective and create content that applies to them specifically.

About/ Educator Credentials Page

My bachelor's degree is in Childhood Education from Hunter College and I am currently in a graduate program at the University of Missouri. The Master's degree is for Learning Technologies in the Information Science and Learning Technologies program. The program takes approximately two years to complete and I am expected to complete it December of 2026. This graduate program is all online, the classes are available remotely. This Learning Technologies and Design program is for those who plan to design and create learning experiences. This degree helps build instructional design skills to help users have the best experiences online. The courses teach research methods, web development, and effective instruction for all types of environments. This can be practiced in corporate, university, k-12, and non-profit environments. Students in these courses are taught how to create and design user interface experiences. Virtual reality and game based learning is also a part of some of the courses.

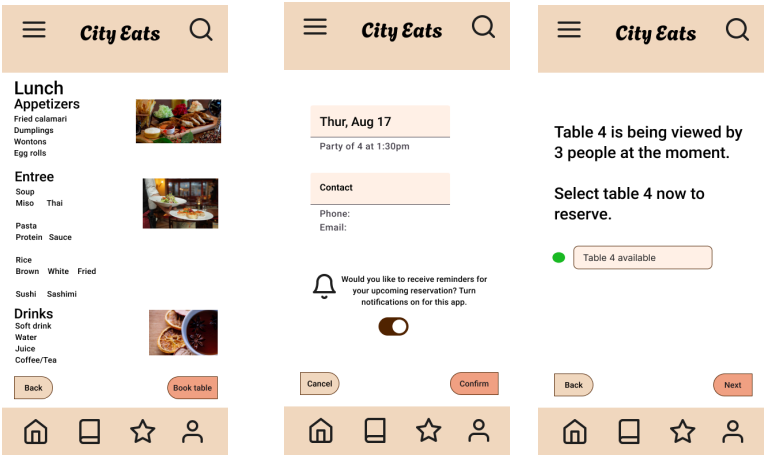
Video link
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1e55P7R-We5egmqNlGN1I18RCxXNW_fEM/view?usp=sharing

Projects/ Experience/ Content

1. **App Design**

An app was designed for a restaurant that wanted its customers to be able to do certain actions online. The client and the restaurant's name is City Eats. The app was named CityEats Time. The client wanted an app that would allow the customers to make reservations online. The customers should also be able to view the menu, book tables, and view real-time availability of the restaurant. The features that the client wanted was for there to be notifications, table preferences, and loyalty rewards. The primary target audience for the app is adults ages 35 and plus. The app was designed with the goal of carrying out 3 user tasks.

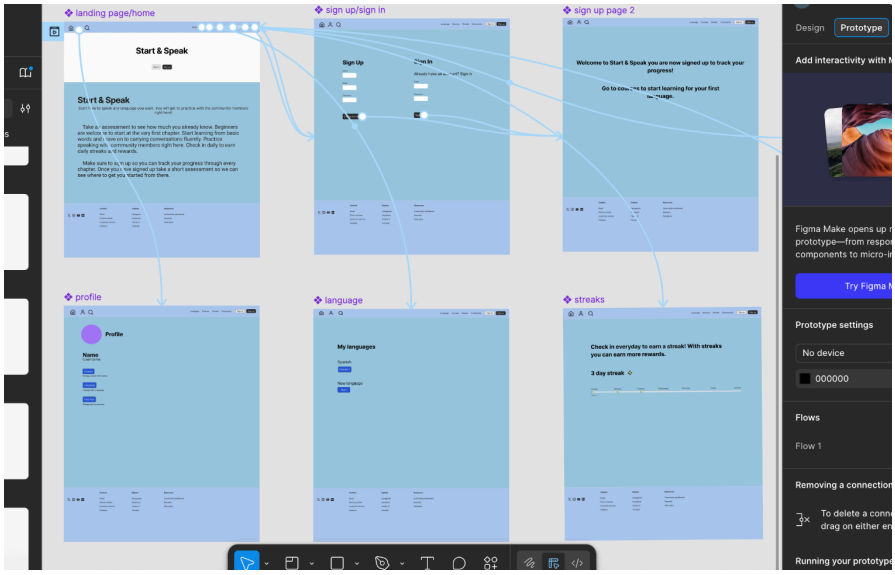
The success metrics for CityEats Time are positive feedback from the first users, high productivity ratings for each feature, and increased engagement with users returning to the app after the first 5 uses. The timeline for this app was set for about 6-8 weeks and the deadlines were met on time. The feedback received for the app was positive. Users liked the simple and organized layout because it is an app that they would not spend too much time on. The users want to come on and quickly make a reservation. Users also liked the option of receiving notifications and being able to view real-time updates on seating. Overall the app was helpful and efficient for the users.

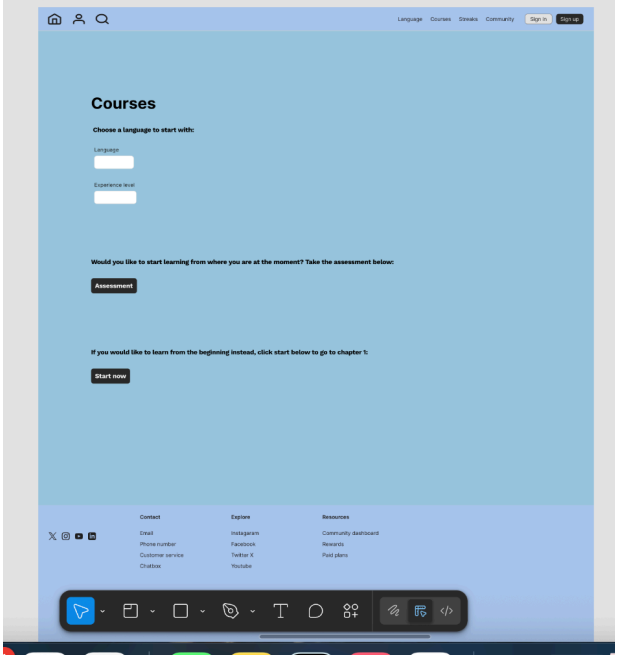


2. **Website Design**

For this website the client wanted something a place for users to learn a new language with a community. The name of the product is Start & Speak and for this project only a website was designed but an app design would be available upon request. The primary target audience here are adults that want to learn a new language by themselves, and immigrants and ESL learners who need to learn to communicate more efficiently. The problem that the client wanted solved is adult language learners struggling to stay motivated and not enough chances to practice with other people. Other language learning products focus more on individual learning and short term goals. The users here need a way to set long term goals and opportunities to practice a language with a community online.

The website was designed with a clean and organized layout. This layout is to make it simple for the users that want to sign in and focus on learning the new language. The features that the users have enjoyed when using this product are the language, courses, and streaks pages. The users have the option of learning more than one language at a time. Before they begin their courses, they are able to take a short assessment to test prior knowledge. The results of the assessment are used to assign the courses best for each specific user. When testing this product, the users really enjoyed that they had a community here where they could practice the language.



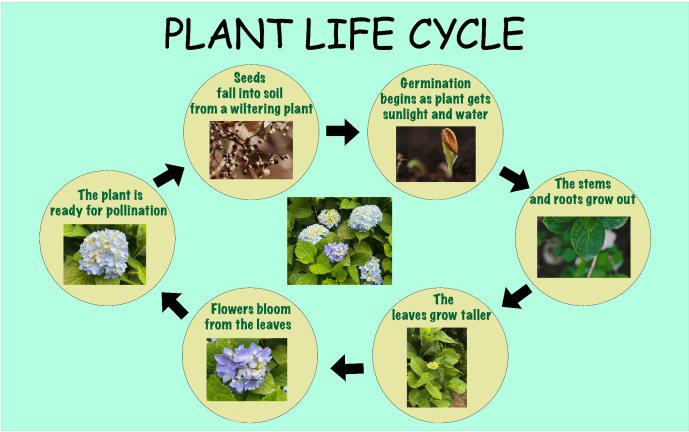


3. **Digital Images with Adobe Photoshop & Illustrate**

This digital image contains simple descriptions and images for each stage in a plant's life cycle. This resource can be used to teach elementary students how life cycles work for living beings such as plants. The purpose is for students to understand the process of a plant's life and how it is a continuous cycle. The techniques used to create this image are basic raster, advanced raster, and basic vector. The design elements seen are contrast, repetition, alignment, and proximity. The skills practiced for this project can be used to create online content for instructional design in the education environment.

This infographic can be used by teachers when they teach their students about life cycles in science class. Teachers can also use it to teach students about plants and how

pollination works. The pointing arrows do not end which shows the learners that this is a continuous cycle that repeats. This can help students understand how crucial pollination is in our ecosystems. The image will be available online to be used in classrooms. The simple text and pictures should allow the learners to read it and grasp the information. Digital images are a great way for learners to work with visuals and skills that promote critical thinking. It is a way to increase engagement between learners and the content. This project shows the skills creators use to create digital images.



Reflection

My undergraduate experience is what has brought me to this point today. For undergrad I chose to major in Childhood Education because I enjoyed working with children. I wanted to help them learn and grow as people who go on to be successful in their futures. I wanted to play a part in making a difference for them in school so they can make positive changes when they leave school. I really enjoyed the teaching part of this field and especially the moment where their face would light up when they understood a topic. The reason I switched from Education to Instructional Design in graduate school is because I wanted to move away from the classroom setting while I still create and teach content.

I have been in the Learning Technologies graduate program for three semesters now and I have learned so much. I was nervous starting off the first semester as I am new to all of the content and to this field. Every course has taught me new skills to carry with me. I am enjoying getting a chance to practice the skills with the assignments in the courses. I really liked this program for the portfolio requirement to graduate. It is a great way for us to build our portfolio during school so we can use it for job opportunities.

With this program I hope to go into UX and UI Design. Out of all of the paths that this degree gives me a chance to explore, I liked this one the most. I had fun with UX and UI Design in the courses here. For my career I am going to aim to start with UX design and see how that goes. After trying that out I might explore more instructional work with training or educational content.

My background in Education has made me view instructional design with the audience as the primary focus. In Education we have to focus on the students, what they need, and what will help them succeed. Every student is different and we had to approach each of them

differently. Depending on the student's background and knowledge we would approach their problems with solutions. No one solution fit every student because they all had different needs and learning styles. The same thing can be applied to the users in instructional design. Every user is different, we cannot apply the same solution to multiple types of users. I will go into instructional design by keeping the users' needs at the top. The most important thing is utilizing design to come up with a solution to their problem. The users' needs have to be top priority in a project and I can best do that by viewing everything from their perspective. We need to see from a user's point of view to successfully carry out a project.